

Runbook — PDPL data residency: move to me-central2 (Dammam) — complete

SECTION 06-operations-it TYPE runbook STATUS **draft** OWNER Founder UPDATED 2026-08-19

[!WARNING] **Retired 2026-08-19** — the migration this runbook planned is **done**, and it was overtaken by a bigger change: the product was ported off Firebase entirely. Every cutover step below (Firestore restore, `firebase auth:import`, Cloud Functions secrets, the `flygaca-app` project, the Stripe/RevenueCat webhooks, the interim `me-central1` compute) refers to infrastructure that no longer exists. Nothing here is runnable, and the "still blocked / needs you" list is not a live to-do list.

The outcome, which is what matters: personal data and the compute that touches it are in `me-central2` (Dammam) — Cloud SQL for PostgreSQL and the Cloud Run API, in the same region, connected over a Cloud SQL unix socket. The interim `me-central1` (Doha) gap is closed.

Go to instead: `../hosting-facts.md` — the PDPL boundary section is the current statement of what lives where and why — and `docs/RUNBOOK-deploy.md` in `iflygaca/FlyGACA`.

The history, in four lines

Worth keeping, because it is the reason the boundary is stated so bluntly everywhere else:

1. The original project put Cloud Firestore in `nam5` (US multi-region) while the public privacy notice claimed Dammam. A Firestore location is permanent, so the database could not be moved.
2. A fresh project was created with the database in `me-central2`, and the eight personal-data records were migrated. Compute ran interim in `me-central1` (Doha) because Cloud Run in Dammam was not yet available on the account.
3. Cloud Run access in `me-central2` was subsequently granted, closing the processing gap.
4. The whole Firebase estate was then replaced by Cloud Run + Cloud SQL, and those projects were deleted.

The rule that survived all of it

All personal data — accounts, profiles, the logbook, real user queries — stays in the Kingdom. Public corpus work can happen on the EU VPS.

And the correction that must never be lost: `me-central1` is **Doha, Qatar**. It is not Riyadh, not "the Kingdom box", and not PDPL-safe. `me-central2` (Dammam) is the only in-Kingdom answer.

[!NOTE] `../04-compliance-ksa/compliance-roadmap.md` and `00-strategy/phase0.md` both still point here for the residency story. The residency conclusion they are citing is correct; the Firebase-era mechanics around it are not.

DRAFT